

THE YOGIC WAY

Naveen Soni, President of Lexus India, believes yoga helps him cut through the clutter and concentrate better

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PHOTO BY **SUDHIR DAMERLA**

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YOGA JOURNEY Naveen Soni was introduced to yoga as part of an employee engagement programme

FOR 56-YEAR-OLD Naveen Soni, President of Lexus India, yoga is a way of life. It all started in 2006-07 when he was still with Toyota and the company started the concept of employee engagement. As a part of that, they did various meaningful activities including setting up a public library, having sessions on leadership, etc. To help employees lead more healthy lives, yoga was introduced. The organisation engaged a yoga guru who would come to the office and post-work there would be a one-hour yoga session for those who were interested. "It was my first introduction to yoga," says Soni, who resides in Bengaluru.

Over the years, as many employees dropped out and others joined, Soni continued to practice regularly. All the way up to 2020 when offices were shut down due to the pandemic. He then started taking online classes. "Online classes give you complete flexibility. Even when I am travelling, I can do an online class and be regular with my yoga session," says Soni.

While he tries to do yoga at least four times a week, he admits that due to time constraints the average is two to three times a week. "Thanks to yoga the body becomes more agile and flexible, and the capacity to take on more physical responsibility increases," says Soni, who took over as President of Lexus India in January 2022.